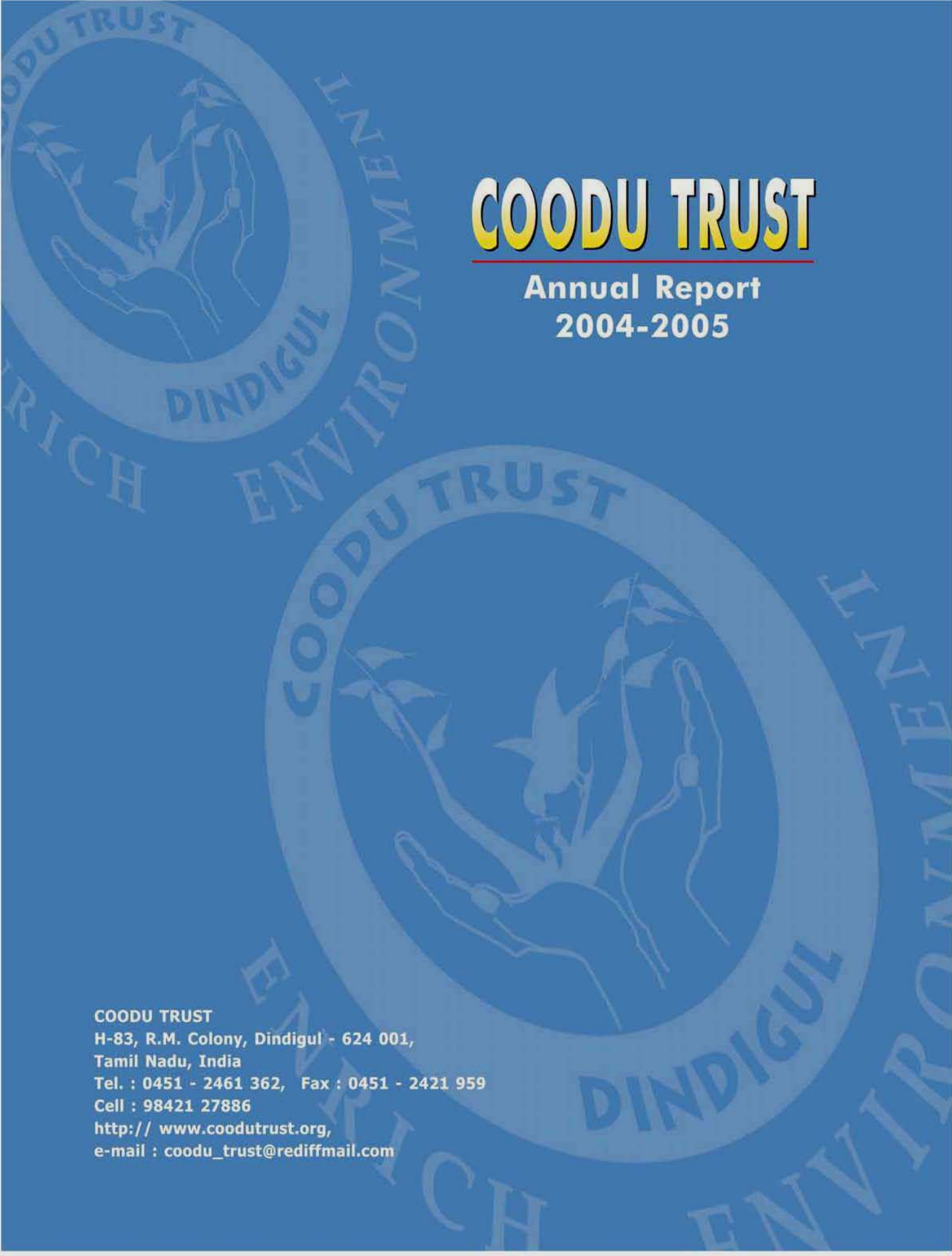




COODU TRUST

**Annual Report
2004-2005**

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ANNUAL REPORT

2004 - 2005

COUNTDOWN TO VISION 2020

Yet another eventful year has passed for Coodu Trust, a pioneer in several key sectors such as agriculture and watershed development, health including HIV/ AIDS and women and child development. Other critical thrust areas included Environmental Development, Water and Sanitation, Training and Research and Relief and Rehabilitation in the light of disasters as Tsunami.

In keeping with its vision of "Creating an egalitarian, self-reliant society adopting the latest technology through participatory approaches", Coodu Trust has marched ahead with tremendous successes in all its ventures primarily in Agriculture and Watershed Management where it has not only enabled creation of physical assets such as check dams, rainwater harvesting structures, de-silted ponds, and construction of natural structures as contour bunds, vegetative fencing and so on, but also empowered communities, especially women Self Help Groups in motivating them to engage in entrepreneurial activities, thrift and savings.

HIV/ AIDS has been another area of focus for Coodu Trust in the

light of the expanding epidemic in Tamil Nadu. The Trust has been instrumental in disseminating information among target groups especially those engaged in high risk behaviours, students through active role in school and college as well as out-of school youth and adolescents in slums and urban settlements. Another important area of focus has been sensitising self-help group women in HIV/ AIDS, giving inputs on correct means on prevention of HIV/ AIDS.

Other key areas of focus of the organisation include Training and Capacity Building of project personnel and targeted audience, providing skill training and training in empowerment of groups, especially women thereby enabling them to attain their goals of economic self-reliance and sustained growth.



Finally, Coodu Trust maintains excellent relations with funding partners, including government and individual philanthropists, banks, cooperatives and other financial institutions, corporate sector, private sector and other leading NGOs, community based organisations working in the targeted districts.

VISION

"Creating an egalitarian, self-reliant by adopting latest and appropriate technologies sustained through participatory community efforts".

MISSION

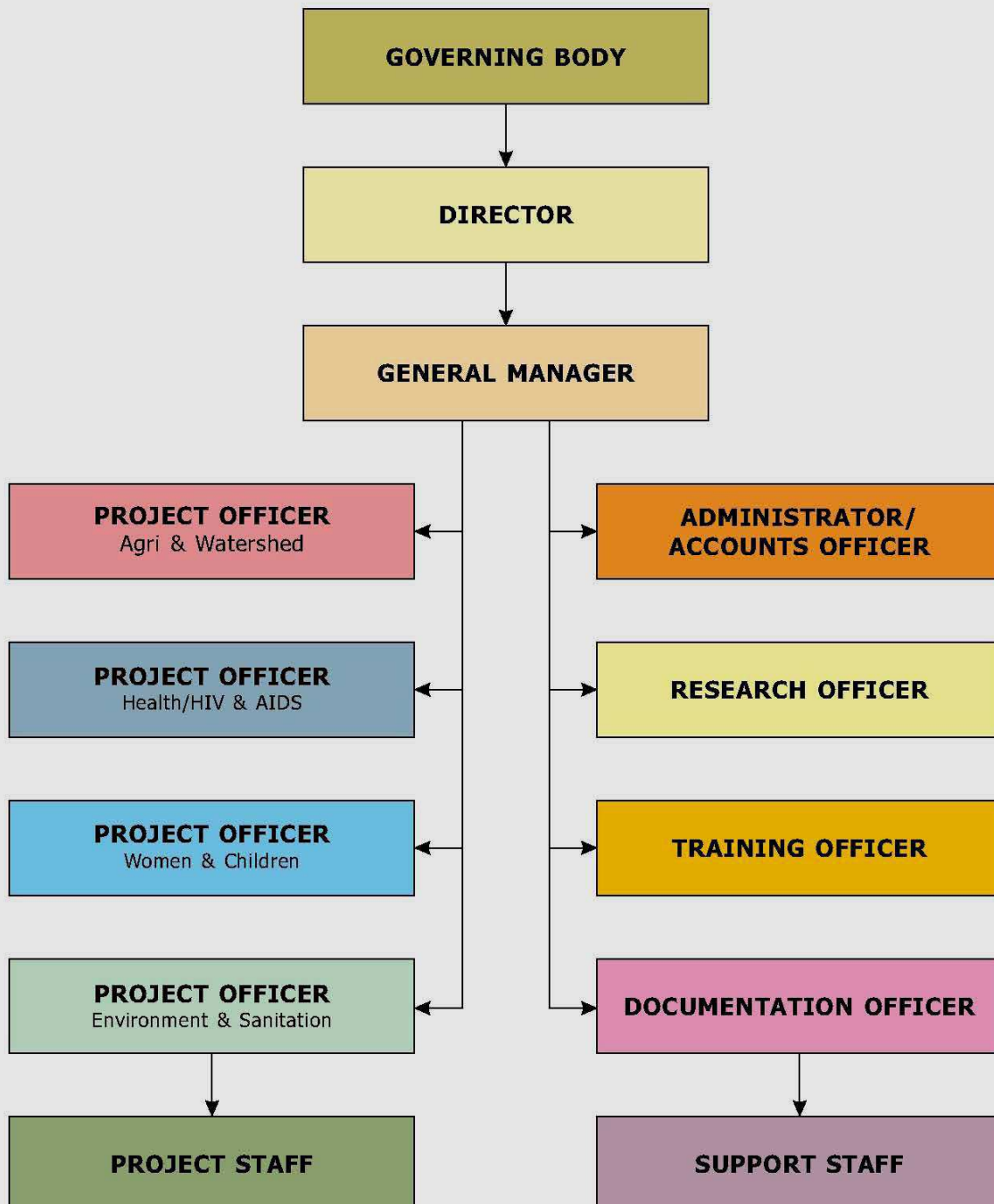
The Mission of Coodu Trust is to create an egalitarian society thereby reducing disparity between classes through a gender-based and human rights approach. It seeks to create a self-reliant society by harnessing use of Information Technology enhancing productivity, speed, accountability and thereby overall efficiency in project management. It also seeks to build relationships within communities by adopting participatory methods, ensuring that the benefits of development reach 'the disadvantaged and marginalised'.

KEY OBJECTIVES

- I Undertake demand-driven, people-centred and action oriented research programmes and projects in different sectors
- I Organise developmental training programmes at various levels
- I Engage in the promotion of sustainable agriculture and rural development
- I Foster development education in different sectors, and enhanced awareness
- I Coordinate and sponsor seminars, and initiate discussion on developmental issues
- I Offer technical support in project design, management, and evaluation of development projects
- I Disseminate development-related information through user-friendly documentation
- I Promote spirit of entrepreneurship aiming toward self-employment and self-reliance thereby attaining sustained growth
- I Transfer low-cost appropriate need-based technologies for the poor
- I Assist in relief work and rehabilitation in the event of natural and man-made disasters

ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE

Coodu trust is being administered by the Governing Body members. There are seven members in the governing body. The Director of Coodu Trust is the Founder and Executive Director and responsible for functioning of activities of Coodu Trust.

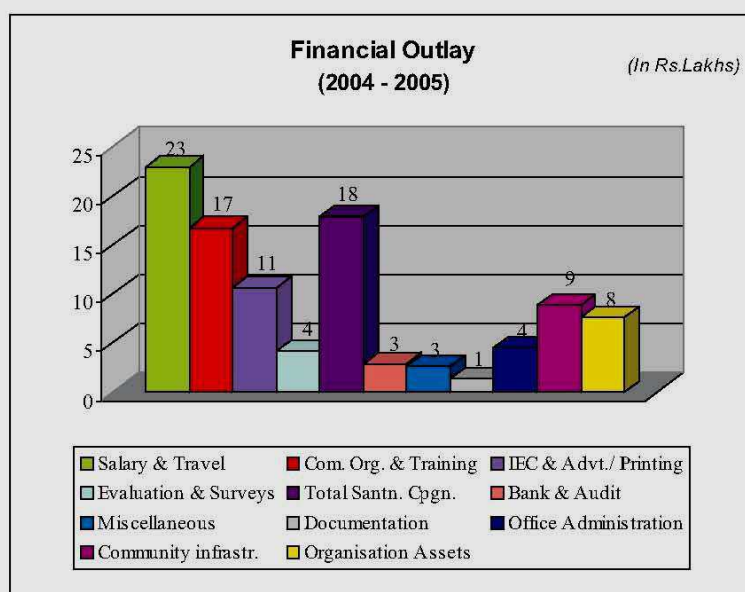


FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE

Following is a summary of financial performance of Coodu Trust in 2004-05.

Sl. No.	Expenditure particulars	Amount (Rs.)
1.	Salary and Travel	23,76,800.00
2.	Community Organisation and Training	17,30,167.00
3.	IEC, advertisements, designing and printing	11,01,976.00
4.	Evaluation, Socio-economic/ Benchmark Surveys	4,29,210.00
5.	Total Sanitation Campaign	18,53,320.00
6.	Bank charges, Audit fees, etc.	2,94,203.00
7.	Miscellaneous expenses	2,66,077.00
8.	Documentation	1,40,720.00
9.	Office Administration	4,61,826.00
10.	Community Infrastructure	9,15,000.00
11.	Organisation Assets	7,90,295.00
	TOTAL	1,03,59,594.00

Graphical presentation of Financial Outlay during the year 2004-05.



ACHIEVEMENTS

Watershed Development Programmes

COODU Trust have been serving as a co-coordinating agency for the implementation of Watershed Development Projects under DPAP, IWDP, TNCWP in rain fed areas in 7 districts of Tamil Nadu. (Details of various watershed projects being implemented district-wise is given in Annexures)

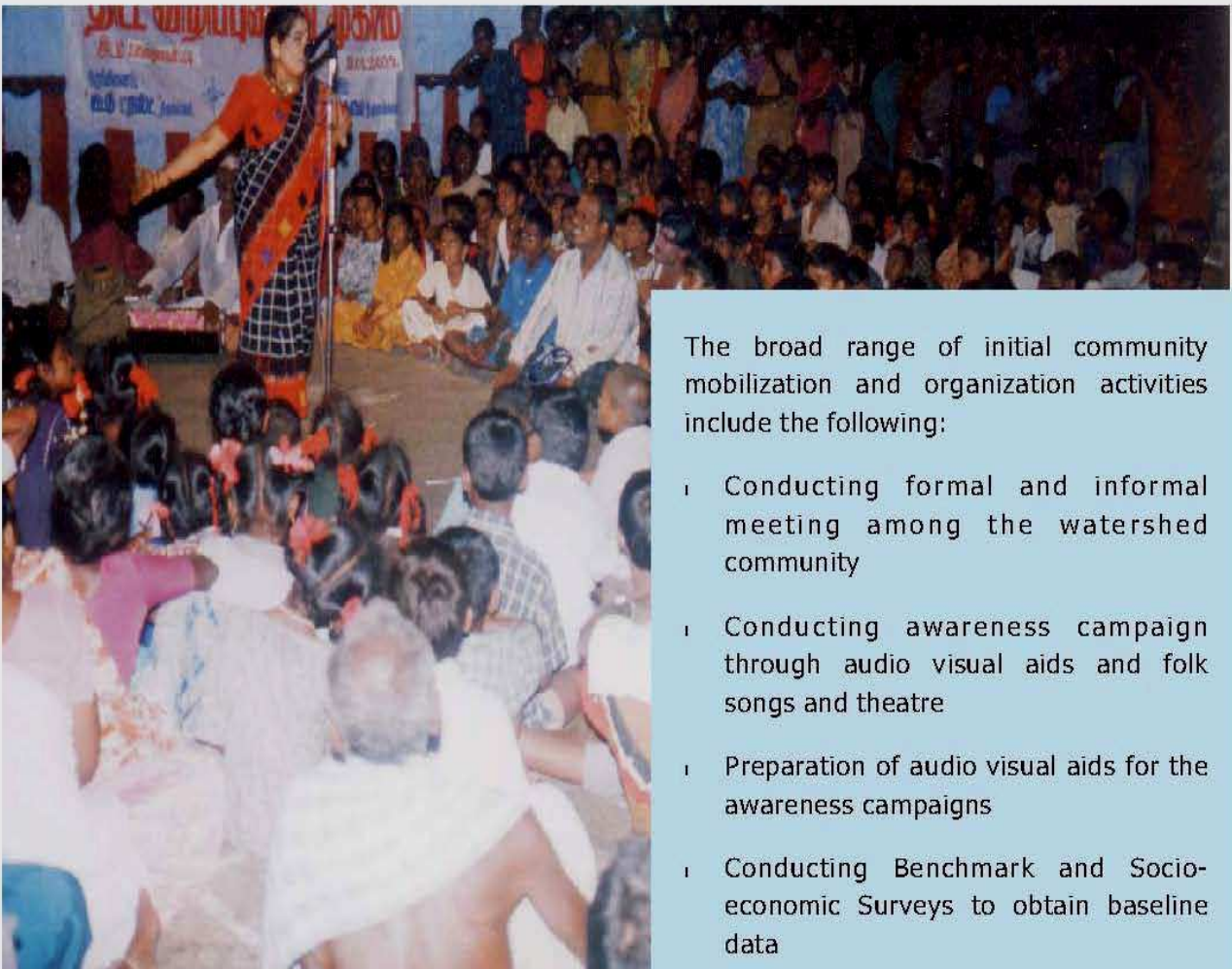
The main objective of the various schemes under Watershed development is to ensure in-situ soil and water conservation and re-greening of wastelands through horticulture, cultivation of medicinal plants and fodder crops. Participatory Watershed Development and Integrated Waste Land Development are the major components of the scheme. Coodu Trust has been engaging



comp in various activities under the watershed approach primarily focusing on community organisation and mobilization, training and capacity building in skills as well as in technology, widening scope of watershed beneficiaries through exposure visits to successful projects, and engaging in plantation activities thereby reclaiming several thousand hectares of wasteland in the state. The focal point of all such activities in the rural areas is the poor, marginalized and socio-economically disadvantaged groups especially women.

Community Organisation Activities

The first step after selection of a watershed and delineation of land based on soil type and structure based on micro-watershed atlas is community mobilization and forming rapport with the people within the selected watersheds. Care is taken to include all key stakeholders including large, medium and small or marginal farmers and women. In each watershed village, institutional structures are established to ensure sustained implementation and participatory monitoring of projects. Thus, village elders, key influential persons, Panchayat representatives, women associations (Mathar Sangams that are later federated into Self Help Groups), youth groups, farmers including women and landless labourers are invited to participate in group level programmes. These formal and informal meetings with the decision-making bodies at the village level help in disseminating information about the project and also instill confidence for support in future activities in the village.



The broad range of initial community mobilization and organization activities include the following:

- Conducting formal and informal meeting among the watershed community
- Conducting awareness campaign through audio visual aids and folk songs and theatre
- Preparation of audio visual aids for the awareness campaigns
- Conducting Benchmark and Socio-economic Surveys to obtain baseline data

- | Conducting Participatory Rural Appraisals (PRAs) in all selected watersheds
- | Capacity Building activities imparting training in technical, managerial, financial areas
- | Formation of Watershed Association and Committees
- | Formation of User Groups
- | Facilitation for preparation of participatory Perspective Watershed Development Plan
- | Conducting managerial and technical training to the established local level institutions
- | Formation and development of Self Help Groups
- | Conducting Participatory Evaluation based on established Performance Indicators
- | Facilitating post-project management and sustainable project activities.

Training in community mobilization and agriculture

In the year 2004-2005, Coodu Trust conducted 39 Trainings under various Watershed projects and schemes such as DPAP, IWDP, TNCWP, NWDPRA and TSC in Dindigul, Karur, Madurai, Trichy, Tirunelveli, Namakkal, Sivagangai, Kanchipuram and Tiruvallur districts. Around 19,755 participants were trained through various programmes on community organization, mobilization and technical know-how. The aim of such training programmes was to provide knowledge in adoption of new technologies, develop new skills for adaptation of appropriate technology, and improve scientific temper among farmers, youth and women.

Significant among the various training programmes was the technological course conducted by Coodu Trust (on kharif and rabi crops) in Palani and Thoppampatti Blocks (Dindigul district) in 10 Watersheds under NWDPRA Scheme in which 600 participants were trained in raising and managing kharif and rabi crops. They in turn, were to train other farmers in their respective villages on this aspect.

Training Themes

The following themes were dealt with under various training programmes:

- | Profitable inter-cropping in irrigated Groundnut
- | Integrated Shoot Webber Management
- | Improved varieties in Green Gram
- | Nutrients application in Sunflower

Under Kharif training programmes the core areas of training included:

- | Integrated Nutrient Management for Groundnut
- | Integrated Disease Management in Kharif Groundnut
- | Rootrot and Phyllody Management in Sesame

Capacity Building of Chief Functionaries of Watershed

In tune with the revised Hariyali guidelines in implementing watershed schemes, Coodu Trust conducted Capacity Building programmes for Chairman, Presidents, Secretaries, and Volunteers in Karur, Trichy, Sivagangai and Kanchipuram districts. Under IWDP and DPAP schemes in 4 districts, 239 participants were trained in watershed management and social aspects for building the capacity of the watershed communities. Key areas of focus in the programmes included emphasis on self-reliance with a view to long-term sustainability of the project and effective post project management, efficient management of land and water resource development of waste lands and improved management of dairy in their areas. Under this training, Farming Systems Approach, Horticulture, Poultry development, Animal Health Care, Homestead Gardening, Solid Waste Management, Effective Micro-Organism were some of the areas of focus. Individuals were trained and encouraged in vegetable cultivation in their own homes.

Participatory Rural Appraisals

Adopting the participatory approach to gathering and analyzing information from the field, Coodu Trust conducted Participatory Rural Appraisals using different PRA techniques such as:

- | Transect Walk
- | Resource Mapping
- | Social Mapping
- | Seasonality Analysis
- | Matrix Ranking
- | Time Line Analysis
- | SWOT Analysis

In order to ascertain the local level problems through the villagers themselves and make them suggest possible solutions to such problems, around 35 PRAs were conducted in Namakkal, Kanchipuram and Tiruchirapalli districts under DPAP, IWDP and TNCWP programmes. The PRAs in the selected 31 watersheds set the ball rolling for enabling local people to plan for equitable and sustainable development.



Exposure Visits

Exposure visits are an important component of Watershed Projects wherein villagers in the selected watersheds visit Agricultural Research stations, successful watersheds, to get first-hand information on innovative technologies and replicable methods and techniques. The key areas of awareness for the participants included Rainwater Harvesting Structures, Biomass production, Drip Irrigation etc. In all, members from 47 watersheds were taken on exposure visits during the year to agriculture research and training institutions in southern and northern districts in the districts.

Plantation Activity

Under the Tamil Nadu Comprehensive Wasteland Programme (TNCWP), Coodu Trust carried out Plantation Activities in several blocks in 4 districts. The details of Plantation activities are as follows:

Sl. No.	Districts	Blocks	Hectares
1.	Dindigul	Nilakottai Acharapakkam Uthramerur	1135 ha
2.	Kanchipuram	Sriperumputhur Mathranthagam Lathur	2100 ha
2.	Tirunelveli	Manoor	750 ha
3.	Namakkal	Erumaipatti	625 ha
4.	Salem	Taramangalam Kolathur	1250 ha

Integrated plantation activities included Summer Ploughing, de-silting of Percolation Ponds, Fodder Development, raising Nurseries, Jatropha Cultivation and Plantations.

Herbal Medicinal Plants

Coodu Trust provided training in raising and cultivation of Herbal Medicinal Plants. Women SHG members were taken to Ammapatty Herbal Medicinal Farm in Sanarpatty Block, Dindigul and trained in Katta Manakku, Illuppai, Eetti, Manjanathi, Paradise Tree, Poongan, Bamb, oo, Cashew, Sapotta, Mango, Neem, Pomegranate, Nellikai, and other commonly grown medicinal plants and herbs. Around 1057 women from SHG were trained in Karur, Trichy and Tirunelveli districts. Watershed members were also taken to the Sivagangai Herbal Medicinal Farm and exposed to various herbs grown in the farm.



Other Skill Trainings

Training on Vermi-composting and Organic Farming

Coodu Trust has, over the past year provided training in selected Watersheds and provided training to 244 women in vermi-composting and organic farming techniques under IWDP and DPAP in Trichy and Karur districts. Women trained in vermi-composting have learnt the skill in enhancing fertility of the soil and helping in reasing yield of crops through organic measures

Training on Mushroom Cultivation

Coodu Trust conducted training on Mushroom cultivation. Selected women in Karur and Trichy District under IWDP and DPAP. 242 women members were trained with a view to provide employment opportunities. Those women who received training gave good feedback and they replied, that they will start Mushroom production unit in their places.



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ed:

Training on the Technology of Effective Micro-organisms

Under the environmental sanitation training, the trainers were enlightened the importance of effective microorganisms and the usage of EM. The EM can be used in gardening, farming, animal husbandry, fish culture, composting and solid waste management, waste water treatment, for elimination of bad odours, for control of flies, cockroaches, mosquitoes, termites and other pests, control of ticks and mites on pets, control of fungus and mould odours on surface cleaning, in drains and toilets, for laundry in ant channels and pools. The various areas of training

- | Advantages of composting with EM
- | Practical procedure
- | Technical details of EM application and cost estimate.
- | EM in agriculture
- | Nursery management
- | Soil fertility and crop management
- | Pest and disease control
- | Weed control
- | Other EM preparations
- | Post harvest management



Training on Cultivation of Jatropa Curcus

Awareness training on Jatropa Curcus was given to the farmers of Karur, Trichy, Triunelveli And Sivagangai district. Farmers were educated on importance of soil fertility, rainfall pattern, agro climate and economic situation. The farmers were proposed a business plan whereby individual farmers could cultivate and sell Jatropa, earning valuable foreign exchange. Nearly 2,00,000 seedlings were produced and distributed to various districts. Coodu trust took initiative to promote the farmers on Jatropa cultivation in 500 hectares.

HIV/ AIDS and Health

HIV/ AIDS Prevention and Control

Viewing the approaching HIV/ AIDS epidemic and its catastrophic effects, Coodu Trust has been in the forefront of HIV/ AIDS prevention and control activities. The range of activities carried out by Coodu has been three-fold: One, engaging in dissemination of IEC materials in Dindigul and neighbouring districts such as Madurai, Theni, Karur, Namakkal and Tiruchirapalli. The AIDS awareness leaflets, posters, stickers are procured from HIV/ AIDS prevention and control agencies. Besides, free condoms are distributed at strategic points among truckers, female commercial sex workers and other high risk groups. Another important component has been engaging in spreading correct messages on HIV/ AIDS among students in schools and colleges. Finally, through its wide network of SHGs, Coodu Trust conducts sensitisation of all women members on HIV/ AIDS, ways of prevention, control, services available and care and support facilities to which women provide referral services.



Public Health

General medical health camps were organised between 2004 - 2005 in three districts in the state, which covers 32 watersheds under IWDP and DPAP projects. With the help of efficient physicians medical camps was conducted. Medicines were distributed to the needy people. General awareness on different diseases and its consequences were highlighted by the medical team and helped the people and the community to follow good and clean habits. Some cases are identified and referred to the Government Hospitals for further medical check-up. Nearly 6253 people got benefited and utilized this opportunity. Coodu Trust has been assisting health department and district health administration of various districts in implementation of Blindness Control Programme, Polio Eradication Programme, TB (DOTS) Programme and STI/ HIV and AIDS programmes by referring people to medical and mobile camps conducted by Government General District Headquarters Hospitals, referrals to district hospitals from PHCs/ Block level hospitals and dispensaries, including rural and urban health posts.



Animal Health (Veterinary Development)

Animal health campaigns were conducted in Karur, Trichirappallai and Sivagangai districts. A team of doctors and medical assistants were organised in the 29 watersheds in the above said three districts. The training imparted on care of animals. The subject content was care of animals, feed management, disease and treatment and economics of rearing. During the camps medicines were supplied to the animals. Around 4660 animals such as cow, hen, buffalo, dog, calf, rabbit, pigeon and goats were screened and treated for various illnesses.

Women Development

Self Help Group Entrepreneurship Training

Self Help Groups were formed to promote savings habit among the women SHG members. Coodu Trust trainers addressed the women in watershed areas to explain about the need for the formation of such groups and the importance of the role of women in Self Help Groups. The selected women were trained on income generating activity such as Mushroom Cultivation and vermi-composting. The self-help group women display enormous courage, unity, discipline, coordination and team spirit. Through such training, around 1162 women were trained. Over time, each of the SHGs evolve through the processes of Group Formation (leading to Federation), Capital Formation through revolving funds, and Skill Development with a view to provide skills development and motivate women to become women entrepreneurs and leaders. The major viable economic activities that trained SHGs have undertaken include: Community Herbal Nursery, Community Nurseries, Vermi-Casting/ Composting Production Centre, and Mushroom Production Centre.

Water and Sanitation Projects

Total Campaign Sanitation Activities in Districts

Training programmes on Environmental Sanitation were organised for Panchayat Presidents Counsellors, Ward Members and Panchayat Level Federation Leaders in Trichy district. Under TSC programme 1448 participants participated in 14 Blocks. The objective of this programme is to make the environment clean and hygienic. The major focus was to concentrate how wastes could be disposed safely without contamination and the methods of disposal of wastes. Core areas of Training in Sanitation included:



- ┆ Composting
- ┆ Recycling
- ┆ Steps involved - solid and waste disposal
- ┆ Safe disposal of liquid wastes
- ┆ Identification of good and bad behaviour on solid waste disposal
- ┆ Safe disposal of human waste.
- ┆ Wastewater disposal by soak pit or kitchen garden
- ┆ Environmental hygiene

The training programme was very well received by the participants. All the participants went for an exposure visit to the Peramangalam in Trichy district and Semipalayam in Coimbatore district. The purpose of this visit was to see model vermi-compost yard and the new technologies adopted by Panchayat leaders and to know efficient management of solid and liquid wastes.

Training on Panchakavya

Training programme on the Panchakavya was conducted to Presidents and Panchayat leaders in environmental sanitation. The participants realized the need and the value of Panchakavya. This programme included discussion on agricultural practices, advanced technology in agriculture and how the organic farming provides opportunities for the use of on-farm resources, how it promotes and enhances agro-ecosystem health including biodiversity, biological cycles and soil biological activities. Participants understood how organic farming sustains soil health, soil moisture conservation and increases farm incomes thereby generating rural employment.



Tsunami Relief and Rehabilitation Measures

In the wake of the untimely Tsunami disaster that wiped out whole villages in coastal Tamil Nadu in December 2004, Coodu Trust immediately sprang into action, regrouping its resources physical, financial and human to mitigate the sufferings of victims of the Tsunami tragedy. Staff and Volunteers of Coodu Trust totally donated a sum of R s . 10,000/- to the "Tamil Nadu Chief Minister's Relief Fund". Besides this, SHG members collected rations, clothes, utensils, essential articles, bedding, cooking stoves, provisions and all necessary materials from several villages and the same was transported to the site of tragedy within three days of the disaster. The Coodu Trust van carrying relief supplies was not intercepted by any one and it managed to reach the most badly affected people in Nagapattinam, Karaikal and Cuddalore districts. Through such valiant efforts, it has been proved that Coodu Trust has the potential of managing extremely difficult crises and meeting the expectations of the poor and needy in times of hardship. The Trust has proved it has the capability of rapid disaster-management and coordinating relief and rehabilitation measures.

In addition to providing immediate relief in Tsunami disaster-affected areas, senior programme staff of Coodu Trust visited all affected places with UNICEF team to assess Water and Sanitation situation and provide inputs on issues such as contamination of potable water in the 57-odd temporary shelters in Nagapattinam as well as analyse the sanitation measures such as open defecation, disposable of solid and liquid wastes in the relief sites. Coodu Trust is poised to provide long term solutions to rehabilitation of Tsunami-affected areas such as housing, water and sanitation, health and education.



Networking and Strengthening Linkages

Coodu Trust has, over the years established good networking with various Government departments Agriculture, Agriculture Engineering, Forests, Horticulture, Health, Environment Rural Development, Education, Women and Child Development, Women Development Corporation, Tamil Nadu State AIDS Control Society (TANSACS), other agencies UNICEF, Banks, etc.

Research and Documentation

Bench Mark And Socio Economic Survey

Coodu trust undertook a Benchmark Study and Socio Economic Survey of all the major blocks in selected districts namely Karur, Sivagangai and Trichy in 2004-2005, where watersheds programmes are being implemented by Coodu Trust. The purpose of this study was to know the characteristics that prevail and conditions of climate, water, social and economic status of the particular area.

Resource-cum-Documentation Centre

Coodu Trust imparted training for watershed communities. The organisation published manuals and pamphlets for the benefit of the project authorities and beneficiaries. Coodu Trust has been implementing number of programmes and creating lot of sets for the benefit of the watershed community of our selected watershed areas ever since the inception of the trust. The organization has set up excellent infrastructure for documenting several projects through using latest digital audio visual aids .All the activities related on watershed related programmes are documented such as action plan for each and every watershed, a model proposal on watershed programmes, health and sanitation, common facility centre, agriculture related information, information on solid waste management, short notes on watershed schemes and training reports are properly maintained in the Coodu Trust. The trust has kept video & CDs on watershed programmes for selected districts where Coodu Trust is working and prepared various CDs and presentations for DRDA, Government of Tamil Nadu.

Moving Forward

- | Agriculture training and applied research on innovative farming systems through use of Organic Farming and utilization of Biogas
- | Providing entire range of services along the entire HIV/AIDS Continuum of Prevention, Treatment, Care and Support
- | Federating SHGs and motivating them to involve in commercially viable activities including exports of indigenous hand-made products to foreign countries
- | Linking villages through Satellite and providing services such as e-mail, e-telephony. Telemedicine and access to computerised land records besides numerous other applications
- | Model building of replicable sustainable integrated rural development project adopting 'convergence' and 'participatory' approach Response in disaster-management including relief and rehabilitation

மரங்கள் மனிதரின் நண்பர்கள்

ஒரு மரம் தனது ஆயுட் காலத்தில்
ரூ.32 லட்சம் மதிப்புள்ள பயன் அளிக்கின்றது

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மரம் வளர்ப்போம்
தேசத்தின் வளம் காப்போம்



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